

Yu Yan

📍 E11-3050, University of Macau, Avenida da Universidade, Taipa, Macau, China ✉ yuyan@um.edu.mo

☎ +853 8822 9165 🌐 yuyan-fintech.github.io

Academic Positions

University of Macau	<i>2026 – Present</i>
Assistant Professor of Financial Technology	

Education

National University of Singapore	<i>2020 – 2026</i>
<i>Ph.D. in Finance, NUS Business School</i>	

Cornell University	<i>Fall 2025</i>
<i>Visiting Ph.D. Student, Digital Economy and Financial Technology (DEFT) Lab</i>	

Jinan University	<i>2016 – 2020</i>
<i>B.A. in Economics, Institute for Economic and Social Research</i>	

Research Interests

FinTech, Decentralized Finance (DeFi), Corporate Governance, Innovation and Entrepreneurship

Publications

From Pitch to Progress: The Interplay of Team Reputation and Governance in Crowdfunded Innovation (with Xin Deng, Yen Teik Lee, & Qi Sun), *Research Policy*, 2026, 55(8), 105526.

Working Papers

(* presented by co-author)

Centralized Governance in Decentralized Organizations

with Lin William Cong, Daniel Rabetti and Charles C.Y. Wang

Presentation: 2026 CES China Annual Conference; AFA 2026*; HARC 2026*; 2025 Global AI Finance Research Conference; 6th Annual RCF-ECGI Conference; FMA 2025; ABR-Fudan Joint Conference; 2025 CEBRA Annual Meeting*; 2025 SAIF Annual Research Conference*; 5th Annual CBER Conference; 18th International Behavioural Finance Conference; 4th Hong Kong Conference for Fintech, AI, and Big Data in Business; 5th Machine Lawyering Conference; 2025 Dishui Lake International Conference in Finance; ABFER 2025; CFMR 2025*; 2025 Forensic Finance Conference*; Digital Economy and Financial Technology (DEFT) Lab Meeting; Harvard Business School Seminar*; 2024 Tokenomics Conference, Waseda Workshop in Decentralized Finance; 2024 Singapore Scholars Symposium; NUS Accounting Brownbag

Open-Source Innovation and Entrepreneurial Activity: Evidence from GitHub

Solo-authored

Presentation: Tsinghua University PBC School of Finance

Teaching Experience

Tutor

Finance (Undergraduate, NUS)	<i>Fall 2023</i>
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Mathematical Analysis (Undergraduate, Jinan University)	<i>Fall 2017</i>
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Teaching Assistant

Corporate Finance (EMBA, NUS)	<i>Aug 2024, Mar 2024</i>
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Financial Management and Markets (EMBA, NUS)	<i>Apr 2023, Sep 2022, July 2022</i>
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Financial Markets (Undergraduate, NUS)	<i>Fall 2022</i>
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Private Equity (MBA, NUS)	<i>Spring 2022</i>
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FinTech and Financial Data Analytics (MBA, NUS)	<i>Spring 2022</i>
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Professional Activities

Keynote Speeches

5th Machine Lawyering Conference (co-presented)

May 2025

Conference Discussions

6th Annual RCF-ECGI Conference

Dec 2025

ABR-Fudan Joint Conference

Sep 2025

18th International Behavioural Finance Conference

Jun 2025

2025 Dishui Lake International Conference in Finance

May 2025

Reviewing Services

Review of Corporate Finance, Hawaii Accounting Research Conference

Selected Awards and Grants

Best Paper Award in Corporate Finance, 2025 FMA Annual Meeting

Oct 2025

Best Discussant of the Session, ABR-Fudan Joint Conference

Sep 2025

Best Paper Prize, 5th Machine Lawyering Conference

May 2025

NUS Research Scholarship

2020-2025

Accomplished Graduate of Jinan University

Jun 2020

Second Prize, The 16th Challenge Cup National College Students' Extracurricular

Nov 2019

Academic Science and Technology Contest

First Prize, Chicago-Jinan Joint Plan Best Paper Competition

Jul 2019

Principal Investigator, Special Funds for the Cultivation of Guangdong College Students' Scientific and Technological Innovation ("Climbing Program" Special Funds)

Jan 2019

Languages and Skills

Languages: Mandarin (Native), English (Fluent)

Skills: Stata, L^AT_EX, R, Python, SQL